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Ultra-compact Reflow-compatible Detachable Optical Connector for Co-Packaged Optics

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Abstract: Ultra-compact detachable optical connector for Co-Packaged Optics (CPO) demonstrates low insertion loss ≤ 0.4 dB with small variation in multiple cycles connections and 260 °C reflow-compatibility.

1. Introduction

Co-packaged Optics (CPO) is highly anticipated as a key enabler to realize higher performance of optical communication in next generation data center (DC) [1, 2]. Integrated circuits (PICs) based on silicon photonic (SiPh) are placed close to application specific function as optical transceivers. For input and output of the light to and from PIC, a connectivity device for PIC/optical fiber connection is necessary. To avoid the complexity during the packaging process of CPO substrate, it is preferable to adopt a detachable connector that can be removed during the packaging process. In CPO, the connector is packaged by the reflow process, the reflow-compatibility is also required for the CPO substrate side. Furthermore, in recent years, it has been reported that a glass substrate is applied as a substrate for CPO [5]. The glass substrate has an advantage of low coefficient of thermal expansion (CTE). It is also possible to form an interface for connection with an external optical fiber by forming a waveguide inside of the glass substrate.

In this paper, we propose an ultra-compact and detachable optical connector for CPO with coupling by a collimated beam with magnetic force connection. We report on the reflow-compatibility. In addition, we demonstrate a concept of high-density multi-channel connectors on glass substrate for CPO by taking advantage of the compact size of the connector.

2. Design concept of detachable optical connector employing collimated beam coupling

In this paper, we develop an optical connector with a 12-channel, 250- μ m pitch in a compact concept for detachable waveguide/optical fiber connector. A waveguide in glass substrate is connected with MT connector-like registration parts. The registration part is made of a transparent resin and is manufactured by injection molding with high productivity. Lens arrays (LAs) are attached to the registration parts with reference to the guide mechanism and fixed, and the waveguide and the FA are actively aligned and fixed to a rear surface of the LAs respectively. The connector is designed to be compatible with the reflow process.